

Kudos to connectivity

Nothing can be a more blissful feeling for a game freak than to vanquish a friend in a 3D encounter at a gaming parlour. If only he could repeat the same feat on his mobile phone. Well, this is possible today, if the game on your Bluetooth handset supports a feature which allows you to play with a friend who also has a Bluetooth handset.

While Bluetooth is rapidly gaining popularity, IR (Infra Red) has been standard for a while now, with mobile devices—Bluetooth and IR modules are flooding the market these days. With these modules, you can actually transfer data from your cell phone to the PC. They make life very easy for those who regularly synchronise contacts, and transfer notes and To Do lists from their phones to their computers.

Bluetooth stands out with some great advantages. It doesn't have any hassles of line-of-sight. In simple words, it works on radio frequencies, and not on light waves, as IR does. This means Bluetooth connectivity will not be disrupted by obstructions. Contrarily, IR transmission works only on line-of-sight, and halts with any obstruction.

Bluetooth has a much faster data transfer rate of 721 Kbps, as compared to 115.2 Kbps for IR. Bluetooth's transfer rate might seem slow compared to the speedy rates we experience on our PCs. But given that the device is, after all, just a handset, its rate of transfer is good enough, with each image being just 40 to 50 KB in size.

With IR or Bluetooth, you can even transfer notes to your PDA or laptop. You have the luxury to click images on your camera phone and immediately transfer it to the PC, or to another handset for touch-ups.

This comes in handy for groups of people with similar connectivity options on their handsets. It provides a new dimension to sharing information, and even lighter moments with friends. This technology actually saves you a lot of cash, since it cuts down the need to exchange SMS or MMS images and notes.

IR-capable printers have been around for a while. Their popularity is really taking off these days. Canon recently launched a printer with an IR port that prints any image it receives, directly from the cell phone—all in a few minutes.

what you need to do, normally, is connect the phone to the PC using the data cable. The image is then copied to the computer, viewed, and printed. So, the IR port here saves a lot of time and trouble—and also eliminates the need for a PC.

Interestingly, these are just a preview of the devices that are being made. Many more devices are planned in the future, and all will communicate with your mobile device to complete almost any function. Imagine how trendy it would be to be able to use your PDA-phone to control almost anything you need to do in your house? Just wait a few years!

Conclusion

The sheer number of features, great looks, great LCD display and good usability saw the Panasonic X70 race ahead of other camera phones in this category. Despite the fact that other phones have slightly better cameras, they lost to the X70 on the grounds mentioned above. The Alcatel Onetouch 735 offers the right balance between features, performance and price to get the Best Value recommendation. The Philip's 535 offers good features, and decent performance to be considered as a good alternative.

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